> “nyet.” Ambassador Hartman (Moscow), came by. He confirms what I believe: the Soviets won’t really negotiate on arms reductions until we deploy the Pershing II’s and go forward with the MX. He also confirms that Andropov is very much out of sight these days.

A few days after I wrote this, the Soviets walked out of the Geneva talks on intermediate-range missiles, and shortly after that, the START discussions on long-range missiles.

They’d left the ballpark, but I didn’t think the game was over.

We had just changed the rules of the game. And they didn’t like it.

The United States was in its strongest position in two decades to negotiate with the Russians from strength. The American economy was booming. We’d come a long way since the late seventies, when our country was plagued with self-doubt and uncertainty and neglecting our military forces.

In spirit and military strength, America was back, and I figured it would be only a matter of time before the Soviets were back at the table—which reminds me of a story I heard about two Russian generals. One of them said to the other:

“You know, I liked the arms race better when there was only one of us in it.”

Now there were two of us in the arms race and the Russians knew it. That’s why I expected them to come back to Geneva.